If you enjoy the intense salty-sweetness of eel, you'll love this German-style soup. Contact your fishmonger in advance to order a fresh eel, asking for it to be prepared.

hamburg eel soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 2 MONTHS

3¼ cups Riesling wine
2 tbsp white wine vinegar
2 tbsp chopped fresh parsley
1 onion, sliced
2 carrots, diced
1 bay leaf
salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 prepared eel (cleaned, skinned, and cut into 2in/5cm pieces)
2 tbsp butter
1½ tbsp flour
2 quarts (2 liters) hot vegetable stock
bouquet garni (see p24)

1 Pour the wine and 2 cups of water into a large saucepan with the vinegar, then add the chopped parsley, onion, carrots, and bay leaf, and season with salt and pepper. Bring to a boil and cook for 4–6 minutes. Add the eel pieces and simmer over low heat for 10 minutes, or until the flesh is tender, then let cool.

2 Melt the butter in a saucepan, add the flour, and cook until blended. Stir in the stock a little at a time. Add the bouquet garni to the pan, and cook slowly for 1 hour.

3 To serve, remove the eel pieces from the cooking liquid. Stir half the cooking liquid into the vegetable stock, divide the eel pieces between six bowls, and ladle the soup over.